

WEB SERIES

The Playlist - Ett svenskt mästerverk

★★★★☆ | If you stream music, then there is a very good chance that you have used or are using Spotify. Ever wondered how this platform came to be? Well, that is the story that plays out in front of you as you sit and watch this absolute masterpiece of a drama miniseries on Netflix.

At the start, the series plays out like a typical business mogul's story. Following the journey of Daniel Ek, played very convincingly by Edvin Endre, the plot opens in a small Swedish apartment, with Daniel and his mother having a



rather comical moment. Not to reveal too much, but it sets the tone right for what events are going to follow as the series moves on.

The first episode is about the birth of the vision of Spotify, and it moves through the founders' tussle with the industry, the law, the lead coder of the app, and the partner, who plays a pivotal role in the series, with things finally coming to a grand end with Spotify being pitted against the artist community.

Each episode is dedicated to one facet of the story of Spotify, from a startup in a basement to a multi-million dollar streaming service. Everything from the pushback from the music industry to the rise and eventual fall of Pirate Bay all fits in like a Lego brick in a showpiece that eventually pans out to be Spotify.

If you were wondering, then yes, we watched the series in Swedish with the subtitles turned on for obvious reasons. And, we'd recommend you to do the same too. As for the leader, in English, it translates to - A Swedish masterpiece.

—Sativik Pandey

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She-Hulk Attorney At Law - End of the charm?

★★★★☆ | There was a time when Marvel could do no wrong. Even the flops they pumped out made a lot of money and, as a part of the larger Marvel Cinematic Universe, fit in neatly in the continuity. Films like Thor: The Dark World and Iron Man 2 weren't great, but they did the job and pushed the studio ahead, culminating in the blockbuster that was Avengers: Endgame.

The MCU was every nerdy kid's dream come true, especially for a more global audience. For a while there, it looked like Kevin Feige was walking on water. But, as it is with the way of the modern world, nothing good ever lasts. Phase Bore *ahem* Phase 4



was, for the lack of a better word, an absolute disaster. The streak of luck had finally come to an end, and all that was left were scraps that Marvel had to work with. The comic book division of Marvel was already a roaring dumpster fire, and the last thing Feige should have done was to adapt the modern, failed comic book storylines. But that's

exactly what he did, and we, as fans, have been paying for it ever since.

So, what is She-Hulk all about? Well, it really is about nothing. There is no character progression, no story beats that really drive the season home. Is it supposed to be an avant-garde, experimental show that pushes the boundaries? No, She-Hulk is just a terrible TV show that tries to pass off as some meta-examination of fandom or some such nonsense. The writers and producers tried to pull in some of the original Marvel fans with 'cameos', but even that was a disaster. Like, what is Megan Thee Stallion, Some kind of super-powered horse in the MCU? No, it's a rapper! And a terrible one at that. They even tried swinging in a Daredevil appearance, but that was handled about as subtly as a jackhammer.

It looks like by now that Marvel is creatively bankrupt. As a comic book collector and fan from a young age, it was our dream to see these characters onscreen. But alas, all good things must come to an end and what an end it is to the MCU.

—Andrew Lu